still, the government. Damage control was the order of the day. Given the court's remarks about the role of the governor, Buta Singh's position appeared untenable. Widespread expectations were that he would either resign or be removed by the government.

However, Singh remained obdurate in the initial moments following the decision. When asked about his intentions following the court's decision, Singh indicated that he would take the Republic Day salute in Patna.[16] The UPA government was increasingly concerned that if it attempted to remove him or compel him to resign, there was a risk that he would turn against the government. Singh 'knew too much', and there was 'no way of knowing what Singh could do, or how he could be controlled after demitting office'.[17] It had long been suspected that the RJD (which was a member of the UPA) had pressured the UPA government to dissolve the assembly on the eve of an attempt to form the state government. The UPA government hardly wanted this confirmed in excruciating detail by one of the protagonists of this episode. Much to the relief of the government, Singh resigned after taking the Republic Day salute on 26 January 2006.

While the Supreme Court did not go so far as to directly censure President Kalam, there were murmurs as to whether he would accept moral responsibility for what was, in the final analysis, a judgement striking down his proclamation dissolving the Bihar Assembly. Kalam seriously contemplated resigning, going as far as discussing his resignation with his brother and his close advisers.[18] He even kept a letter of resignation ready. It was Prime Minister Manmohan Singh who persuaded the President not to resign, stating that it could result in the UPA government itself toppling.[19] A governor and a state government were casualties during this episode. The President – in particular, among India's most respected and popular Presidents – escaped only narrowly.